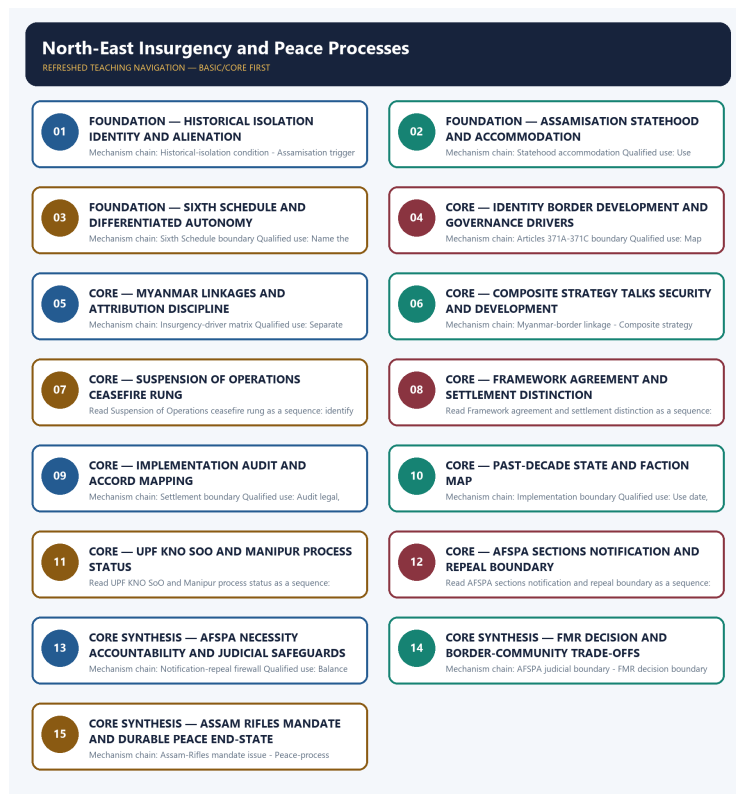


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

North-East Insurgency and Peace Processes - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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North-East Insurgency and Peace Processes - Learner-v2

Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-04. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-04.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. OCR-searchable official UPSC papers were supplementary only for printed routed demands. No answer key, attribution, operational method, notification effect, implementation outcome or security metric was inferred.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** The audited GS-III ledgers route the 2019 India-Myanmar-border demand and the 2025 North-East challenges-and-accord-map demand here. Every instrument retains its date, State or faction and legal/status rung; signature is never rewritten as implementation.
- **Live-link boundary:** The current anchors are notification- and instrument-specific: the 8 February 2024 FMR decision remains an announcement unless supported by an operative notification; the 4 September 2025 UPF/KNO instrument remains an SoO; and 2026 disturbed-area notifications do not repeal AFSPA.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

LIVE OFFICIAL-SOURCE ATTEMPT LOG

The checks below were made on 2026-09-04. Substantive official text is used only for the proposition it supports; title-only, blocked or thin pages are recorded and supply no factual claim.

- https://www.mha.gov.in/sites/default/files/AREnglish_24032026.pdf - attempted 2026-09-04; direct retrieval returned 403, while the canonical owner uses the MHA Annual Report 2024-25 for dated accord mapping. The module does not infer implementation from signature.
- <https://pib.gov.in/FeaturesDeatils.aspx?NotelId=151186&ModuleId=2> - searched 2026-09-04; the official PIB feature provides a public North-East peace-and-accord overview. Every entry remains classified as ceasefire, framework, settlement or separately verified implementation rather than one undifferentiated success count.
- <https://www.mha.gov.in/> - searched 2026-09-04 for the 2026 AFSPA disturbed-area notifications and the 23 April 2026 North-East peace-process update. The module preserves notification-specific and time-bound status without treating reduced coverage as repeal.
- <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/> - searched 2026-09-04 for AFSPA 1958 and constitutional autonomy provisions; the module uses sections 3, 4 and 6 plus Articles 244(2), 371A and 371C as owner-audited legal anchors, not as proof of current field conditions.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Internal Security Basic/Core is easy-first and answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Threat boundary	Actor, intent, capability, geography, target, harm and security-development nexus remain distinct.
Law/status boundary	Constitution, statute, rule, notification, guideline, advisory, designation, investigation, prosecution, conviction and measured outcome are not conflated.
Institutional boundary	Intelligence, police, NIA, prosecution, courts, CAPFs, armed forces, CERT-In, NCIIPC, I4C, Coast Guard and regulators retain exact mandates and federal limits.
Process boundary	Prevention, preparedness, response, investigation, prosecution, recovery and resilience are separate stages.
Current-data boundary	Every incident, casualty, budget, force, border, seizure, conviction, timeline and operational claim keeps source, date, unit, jurisdiction and status.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, detailed examiner-grade model, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
PYQ contract	Official wording and keys are asserted only when verified; routed or reconstructed demands remain labelled.
Dual-flow contract	Graphical and ASCII masters independently reconstruct the same complete Basic-to-optional-Advanced evidence spine.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Internal-Security\basic\04_North-East-Insurgency-and-Peace-Processes.md **Substantive canonical provenance owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Internal-Security\learning-sessions\v2\subject-wide-syllabus\internal-security-04_Learning-Session.md **Optional Advanced owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Internal-Security\advanced\04_North-East-Insurgency-and-Peace-Processes.md **Official syllabus mapping:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Internal-Security\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- Law is separated from rules, notifications, guidelines and advisories; designation from conviction; investigation from prosecution.
- Intelligence is separated from admissible evidence; ceasefire/framework agreement from final settlement and implementation.
- Border guarding is separated from law and order; cyber incident from cybercrime; prevention from response; security output from development outcome.
- Every current Jammu and Kashmir, border, insurgency, terrorism, cyber, maritime, organised-crime, force or legal-status claim retains source/date/status.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-06:** failed official fetches remain explicit and supply no invented fact.

Generation-local live/current sources:

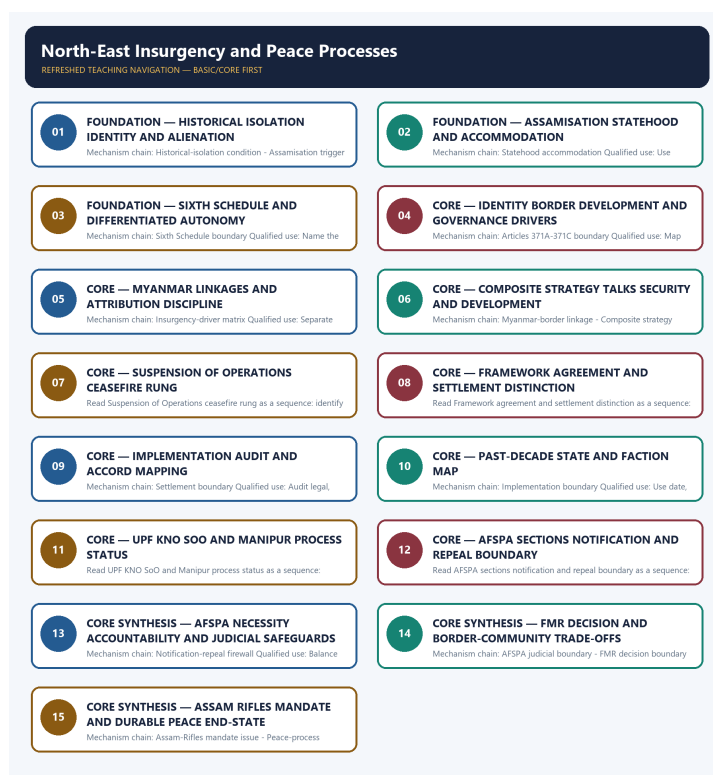
- https://www.mha.gov.in/sites/default/files/AREnglish_24032026.pdf - attempted 2026-09-04; direct retrieval returned 403, while the canonical owner uses the MHA Annual Report 2024-25 for dated accord mapping. The module does not infer implementation from signature.
- <https://pib.gov.in/FeaturesDeatils.aspx?NoteId=151186&ModuleId=2> - searched 2026-09-04; the official PIB feature provides a public North-East peace-and-accord overview. Every entry remains classified as ceasefire, framework, settlement or separately verified implementation rather than one undifferentiated success count.
- <https://www.mha.gov.in/> - searched 2026-09-04 for the 2026 AFSPA disturbed-area notifications and the 23 April 2026 North-East peace-process update. The module

preserves notification-specific and time-bound status without treating reduced coverage as repeal.

- <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/> - searched 2026-09-04 for AFSPA 1958 and constitutional autonomy provisions; the module uses sections 3, 4 and 6 plus Articles 244(2), 371A and 371C as owner-audited legal anchors, not as proof of current field conditions.

Topic-routed verified PYQ owners:

- Repository PYQ routing ledgers control wording, year, marks and verification status.



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - HISTORICAL ISOLATION IDENTITY AND ALIENATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Historical isolation identity and alienation as a sequence: identify Historical-isolation condition, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Historical-isolation condition - Assamisation trigger Qualified use: Explain historical condition without making it a deterministic cause.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Historical isolation identity and alienation as a sequence: identify Historical-isolation condition, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Historical isolation identity

- alienation
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- British

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Historical isolation identity, connect alienation with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

HISTORICAL ISOLATION IDENTITY AND ALIENATION

01. Historical-isolation condition

|

v

02. Assamisation trigger

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not treat the North-East as one homogeneous insurgency.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Historical isolation identity and alienation as a sequence: identify Historical-isolation condition, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not treat the North-East as one homogeneous insurgency. This keeps Historical-isolation condition and Assamisation trigger in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East.
- The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat the North-East as one homogeneous insurgency.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Explain historical condition without making it a deterministic cause.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Historical-isolation condition -> Assamisation trigger
- **Qualified use:** Explain historical condition without making it a deterministic cause.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - HISTORICAL ISOLATION IDENTITY AND ALIENATION

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Historical isolation identity and alienation

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Historical isolation identity · alienation · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · British

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Historical-isolation condition - Assamisation trigger
Qualified use: Explain historical condition without making it a deterministic cause.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not treat the North-East as one homogeneous insurgency.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Historical isolation identity and alienation as a sequence: identify Historical-isolation condition, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - ASSAMISATION STATEHOOD AND ACCOMMODATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Assamisation statehood and accommodation as a sequence: identify Statehood accommodation, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Statehood accommodation Qualified use: Use territorial reorganisation as political accommodation evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Assamisation statehood and accommodation as a sequence: identify Statehood accommodation, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Assamisation statehood
- accommodation
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Nagaland

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Assamisation statehood, connect accommodation with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

ASSAMISATION STATEHOOD AND ACCOMMODATION

01. Statehood accommodation

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not treat every autonomy demand as a Sixth Schedule demand.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Assamisation statehood and accommodation as a sequence: identify Statehood accommodation, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not treat every autonomy demand as a Sixth Schedule demand. This keeps Statehood accommodation in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat every autonomy demand as a Sixth Schedule demand.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Use territorial reorganisation as political accommodation evidence.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Statehood accommodation
- **Qualified use:** Use territorial reorganisation as political accommodation evidence.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - ASSAMISATION STATEHOOD AND ACCOMMODATION

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Assamisation statehood and accommodation

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Assamisation statehood • accommodation • Mechanism chain • Qualified use
• Nagaland

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Statehood accommodation Qualified use: Use territorial reorganisation as political accommodation evidence.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not treat every autonomy demand as a Sixth Schedule demand.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not treat every autonomy demand as a Sixth Schedule demand.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Assamisation statehood and accommodation as a sequence: identify Statehood accommodation, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - SIXTH SCHEDULE AND DIFFERENTIATED AUTONOMY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Sixth Schedule and differentiated autonomy as a sequence: identify Sixth Schedule boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Sixth Schedule boundary Qualified use: Name the exact constitutional instrument for the exact State.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Sixth Schedule
- differentiated autonomy
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- The Sixth Schedule

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Sixth Schedule, connect differentiated autonomy with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SIXTH SCHEDULE AND DIFFERENTIATED AUTONOMY

01. Sixth Schedule boundary

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not confuse SoO, framework agreement, settlement and implementation.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Sixth Schedule and differentiated autonomy as a sequence: identify Sixth Schedule boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not confuse SoO, framework agreement, settlement and implementation. This keeps Sixth Schedule boundary in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not confuse SoO, framework agreement, settlement and implementation.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Name the exact constitutional instrument for the exact State.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Sixth Schedule boundary
- **Qualified use:** Name the exact constitutional instrument for the exact State.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - SIXTH SCHEDULE AND DIFFERENTIATED AUTONOMY

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Sixth Schedule and differentiated autonomy

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Sixth Schedule • differentiated autonomy • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • The Sixth Schedule

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Read Sixth Schedule and differentiated autonomy as a sequence: identify Sixth Schedule boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mechanism chain: Sixth Schedule boundary Qualified use: Name the exact constitutional instrument for the exact State.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not confuse SoO, framework agreement, settlement and implementation.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.

SESSION 4 - CORE - IDENTITY BORDER DEVELOPMENT AND GOVERNANCE DRIVERS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Identity border development and governance drivers as a sequence: identify Articles 371A-371C boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Articles 371A-371C boundary Qualified use: Map drivers State by State rather than homogenising the region.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Identity border development and governance drivers as a sequence: identify Articles 371A-371C boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Identity border development
- governance drivers
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Article 371A
- Article 371C

How to use them: Frame the answer through Identity border development; define governance drivers, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Article 371A for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

IDENTITY BORDER DEVELOPMENT AND GOVERNANCE DRIVERS

01. Articles 371A-371C boundary

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not call an SoO disarmament or rehabilitation.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Identity border development and governance drivers as a sequence: identify Articles 371A-371C boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not call an SoO disarmament or rehabilitation. This keeps Articles 371A-371C boundary in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call an SoO disarmament or rehabilitation.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Map drivers State by State rather than homogenising the region.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Articles 371A-371C boundary
- **Qualified use:** Map drivers State by State rather than homogenising the region.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - IDENTITY BORDER DEVELOPMENT AND GOVERNANCE DRIVERS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Identity border development and governance drivers

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Identity border development · governance drivers · Mechanism chain · Qualified use ·
Article 371A · Article 371C

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Articles 371A-371C boundary Qualified use: Map drivers State
by State rather than homogenising the region.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A,
while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the
Sixth Schedule.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not call an SoO disarmament or rehabilitation.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Identity border development and governance drivers as a sequence:
identify Articles 371A-371C boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and
stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 5 - CORE - MYANMAR LINKAGES AND ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Myanmar linkages and attribution discipline as a sequence: identify Insurgency-driver matrix, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Insurgency-driver matrix Qualified use: Separate cross-border vulnerability from current group attribution.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Myanmar linkages and attribution discipline as a sequence: identify Insurgency-driver matrix, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Myanmar linkages
- attribution discipline
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Identity
- States

How to use them: Frame the answer through Myanmar linkages; define attribution discipline, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Identity for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MYANMAR LINKAGES AND ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE

01. Insurgency-driver matrix

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not call the 2015 Framework Agreement a final Naga settlement.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Myanmar linkages and attribution discipline as a sequence: identify Insurgency-driver matrix, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not call the 2015 Framework Agreement a final Naga settlement. This keeps Insurgency-driver matrix in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call the 2015 Framework Agreement a final Naga settlement.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Separate cross-border vulnerability from current group attribution.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Insurgency-driver matrix
- **Qualified use:** Separate cross-border vulnerability from current group attribution.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - MYANMAR LINKAGES AND ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Myanmar linkages and attribution discipline

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Myanmar linkages · attribution discipline · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Identity
· States

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Insurgency-driver matrix Qualified use: Separate cross-border vulnerability from current group attribution.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not call the 2015 Framework Agreement a final Naga settlement.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not call the 2015 Framework Agreement a final Naga settlement.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Myanmar linkages and attribution discipline as a sequence: identify Insurgency-driver matrix, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 6 - CORE - COMPOSITE STRATEGY TALKS SECURITY AND DEVELOPMENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Composite strategy talks security and development as a sequence: identify Myanmar-border linkage, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Myanmar-border linkage - Composite strategy Qualified use: Show accommodation and lawful coercion as parallel calibrated tracks.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Composite strategy talks security and development as a sequence: identify Myanmar-border linkage, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Composite strategy talks security**
- **development**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Read Composite**
- **Myanmar-border**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Composite strategy talks security; define development, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Read Composite for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

COMPOSITE STRATEGY TALKS SECURITY AND DEVELOPMENT

01. Myanmar-border linkage

|

v

02. Composite strategy

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not treat accord signature as implemented peace.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Composite strategy talks security and development as a sequence: identify Myanmar-border linkage, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not treat accord signature as implemented peace. This keeps Myanmar-border linkage and Composite strategy in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence.
- The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat accord signature as implemented peace.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Show accommodation and lawful coercion as parallel calibrated tracks.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Myanmar-border linkage -> Composite strategy
- **Qualified use:** Show accommodation and lawful coercion as parallel calibrated tracks.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - COMPOSITE STRATEGY TALKS SECURITY AND DEVELOPMENT

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Composite strategy talks security and development

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Composite strategy talks security • development • Mechanism chain • Qualified use •

Read Composite • Myanmar-border

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Myanmar-border linkage - Composite strategy Qualified use:

Show accommodation and lawful coercion as parallel calibrated tracks.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not treat accord signature as implemented peace.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not treat accord signature as implemented peace.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Composite strategy talks security and development as a sequence: identify Myanmar-border linkage, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 7 - CORE - SUSPENSION OF OPERATIONS CEASEFIRE RUNG

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

Technical definition: Read Suspension of Operations ceasefire rung as a sequence: identify SoO boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Suspension of Operations ceasefire rung
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- A Suspension of Operations agreement
- Suspension
- Operations

How to use them: Frame the answer through Suspension of Operations ceasefire rung; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with A Suspension of Operations agreement to explain the mechanism, and use Suspension for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SUSPENSION OF OPERATIONS CEASEFIRE RUNG

01. SoO boundary

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not equate reduced disturbed-area coverage with AFSPA repeal.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Suspension of Operations ceasefire rung as a sequence: identify SoO boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not equate reduced disturbed-area coverage with AFSPA repeal. This keeps SoO boundary in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not equate reduced disturbed-area coverage with AFSPA repeal.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** State ground-rule purpose and stop before disarmament claims.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** SoO boundary
- **Qualified use:** State ground-rule purpose and stop before disarmament claims.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SUSPENSION OF OPERATIONS CEASEFIRE RUNG

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Suspension of Operations ceasefire rung

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Suspension of Operations ceasefire rung • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • A
Suspension of Operations agreement • Suspension • Operations

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Read Suspension of Operations ceasefire rung as a sequence: identify SoO
boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified
status rather than assuming the next stage.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not equate reduced disturbed-area coverage with
AFSPA repeal.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not equate reduced disturbed-area coverage with AFSPA repeal.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable
cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political
settlement or verified rehabilitation.

SESSION 8 - CORE - FRAMEWORK AGREEMENT AND SETTLEMENT DISTINCTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.

Technical definition: Read Framework agreement and settlement distinction as a sequence: identify Framework-agreement boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Framework agreement**
- **settlement distinction**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **NSCN**
- **IM**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Framework agreement; define settlement distinction, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use NSCN for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

FRAMEWORK AGREEMENT AND SETTLEMENT DISTINCTION

01. Framework-agreement boundary

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not describe AFSPA as absolute immunity.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Framework agreement and settlement distinction as a sequence: identify Framework-agreement boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not describe AFSPA as absolute immunity. This keeps Framework-agreement boundary in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not describe AFSPA as absolute immunity.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Identify the rung before assessing progress.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Framework-agreement boundary
- **Qualified use:** Identify the rung before assessing progress.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - FRAMEWORK AGREEMENT AND SETTLEMENT DISTINCTION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Framework agreement and settlement distinction

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Framework agreement · settlement distinction · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · NSCN · IM

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Read Framework agreement and settlement distinction as a sequence: identify Framework-agreement boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not describe AFSPA as absolute immunity.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not describe AFSPA as absolute immunity.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.

SESSION 9 - CORE - IMPLEMENTATION AUDIT AND ACCORD MAPPING

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Implementation audit and accord mapping as a sequence: identify Settlement boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Settlement boundary Qualified use: Audit legal, fiscal and reintegration follow-through separately.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Implementation audit and accord mapping as a sequence: identify Settlement boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Implementation audit
- accord mapping
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Memorandum
- Settlement

How to use them: Frame the answer through Implementation audit; define accord mapping, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Memorandum for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

IMPLEMENTATION AUDIT AND ACCORD MAPPING

01. Settlement boundary

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not convert the 2024 FMR decision into operational abolition without notification.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Implementation audit and accord mapping as a sequence: identify Settlement boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not convert the 2024 FMR decision into operational abolition without notification. This keeps Settlement boundary in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not convert the 2024 FMR decision into operational abolition without notification.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Audit legal, fiscal and reintegration follow-through separately.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Settlement boundary
- **Qualified use:** Audit legal, fiscal and reintegration follow-through separately.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - IMPLEMENTATION AUDIT AND ACCORD MAPPING

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Implementation audit and accord mapping

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Implementation audit • accord mapping • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • Memorandum • Settlement

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Settlement boundary Qualified use: Audit legal, fiscal and reintegration follow-through separately.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not convert the 2024 FMR decision into operational abolition without notification.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Implementation audit and accord mapping as a sequence: identify Settlement boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 10 - CORE - PAST-DECADE STATE AND FACTION MAP

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Past-decade State and faction map as a sequence: identify Implementation boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Implementation boundary Qualified use: Use date, State, faction and instrument type in every map entry.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Past-decade State and faction map as a sequence: identify Implementation boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Past-decade State**
- **ion map**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Implementation**
- **Read Past-decade State**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Past-decade State; define ion map, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Implementation for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PAST-DECADE STATE AND FACTION MAP

01. Implementation boundary

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not carry book-period group strength or status into the present.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Past-decade State and faction map as a sequence: identify Implementation boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not carry book-period group strength or status into the present. This keeps Implementation boundary in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not carry book-period group strength or status into the present.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Use date, State, faction and instrument type in every map entry.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Implementation boundary
- **Qualified use:** Use date, State, faction and instrument type in every map entry.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - PAST-DECADE STATE AND FACTION MAP

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Past-decade State and faction map

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Past-decade State · ion map · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Implementation · Read Past-decade State

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Implementation boundary Qualified use: Use date, State, faction and instrument type in every map entry.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not carry book-period group strength or status into the present.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not carry book-period group strength or status into the present.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Past-decade State and faction map as a sequence: identify Implementation boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 11 - CORE - UPF KNO SOO AND MANIPUR PROCESS STATUS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

Technical definition: Read UPF KNO SoO and Manipur process status as a sequence: identify Past-decade accord map, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- UPF KNO SoO
- Manipur process status
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Revised
- 2025-26

How to use them: Frame the answer through UPF KNO SoO; define Manipur process status, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Revised for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

UPF KNO SOO AND MANIPUR PROCESS STATUS

01. Past-decade accord map

|
v

02. UPF-KNO SoO status

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not use border hardening as the only peace-process answer.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read UPF KNO SoO and Manipur process status as a sequence: identify Past-decade accord map, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not use border hardening as the only peace-process answer. This keeps Past-decade accord map and UPF-KNO SoO status in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status.
- Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not use border hardening as the only peace-process answer.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Keep the 2025-26 instrument at ceasefire status.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Past-decade accord map -> UPF-KNO SoO status
- **Qualified use:** Keep the 2025-26 instrument at ceasefire status.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - UPF KNO SOO AND MANIPUR PROCESS STATUS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - UPF KNO SoO and Manipur process status

|

v

EXACT TERMS: UPF KNO SoO · Manipur process status · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Revised · 2025-26

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Read UPF KNO SoO and Manipur process status as a sequence: identify Past-decade accord map, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not use border hardening as the only peace-process answer.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not use border hardening as the only peace-process answer.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

SESSION 12 - CORE - AFSPA SECTIONS NOTIFICATION AND REPEAL BOUNDARY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The decisive boundary is Do not publish tactical camp, movement or force-deployment detail.

Technical definition: Read AFSPA sections notification and repeal boundary as a sequence: identify AFSPA sections, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read AFSPA sections notification and repeal boundary as a sequence: identify AFSPA sections, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **AFSPA sections notification**
- **repeal boundary**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Under AFSPA**
- **Central Government**

How to use them: Frame the answer through AFSPA sections notification; define repeal boundary, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Under AFSPA for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

AFSPA SECTIONS NOTIFICATION AND REPEAL BOUNDARY

01. AFSPA sections

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not publish tactical camp, movement or force-deployment detail.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read AFSPA sections notification and repeal boundary as a sequence: identify AFSPA sections, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not publish tactical camp, movement or force-deployment detail. This keeps AFSPA sections in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not publish tactical camp, movement or force-deployment detail.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Separate the Act, notification footprint and repeal.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** AFSPA sections
- **Qualified use:** Separate the Act, notification footprint and repeal.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - AFSPA SECTIONS NOTIFICATION AND REPEAL BOUNDARY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - AFSPA sections notification and repeal boundary

|

v

EXACT TERMS: AFSPA sections notification • repeal boundary • Mechanism chain • Qualified use •
Under AFSPA • Central Government

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: AFSPA sections Qualified use: Separate the Act, notification footprint and repeal.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not publish tactical camp, movement or force-deployment detail.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read AFSPA sections notification and repeal boundary as a sequence: identify AFSPA sections, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - AFSPA NECESSITY ACCOUNTABILITY AND JUDICIAL SAFEGUARDS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read AFSPA necessity accountability and judicial safeguards as a sequence: identify Notification-repeal firewall, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Notification-repeal firewall Qualified use: Balance operational necessity with investigation and accountability.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read AFSPA necessity accountability and judicial safeguards as a sequence: identify Notification-repeal firewall, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- AFSPA necessity accountability
- judicial safeguards
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Shrinking

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define AFSPA necessity accountability, connect judicial safeguards with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

AFSPA NECESSITY ACCOUNTABILITY AND JUDICIAL SAFEGUARDS

01. Notification-repeal firewall

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not treat the North-East as one homogeneous insurgency.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read AFSPA necessity accountability and judicial safeguards as a sequence: identify Notification-repeal firewall, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not treat the North-East as one homogeneous insurgency. This keeps Notification-repeal firewall in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat the North-East as one homogeneous insurgency.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Balance operational necessity with investigation and accountability.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Notification-repeal firewall
- **Qualified use:** Balance operational necessity with investigation and accountability.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - AFSPA NECESSITY ACCOUNTABILITY AND JUDICIAL SAFEGUARDS

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - AFSPA necessity accountability and judicial safeguards
|
v
EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · AFSPA necessity accountability · judicial safeguards · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Shrinking
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Notification-repeal firewall Qualified use: Balance operational necessity with investigation and accountability.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not treat the North-East as one homogeneous insurgency.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not treat the North-East as one homogeneous insurgency.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read AFSPA necessity accountability and judicial safeguards as a sequence: identify Notification-repeal firewall, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - FMR DECISION AND BORDER-COMMUNITY TRADE-OFFS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read FMR decision and border-community trade-offs as a sequence: identify AFSPA judicial boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: AFSPA judicial boundary - FMR decision boundary Qualified use: Distinguish announced policy from notified implementation and livelihood effects.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **FMR decision**
- **border-community trade-offs**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **MHA**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define FMR decision, connect border-community trade-offs with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

FMR DECISION AND BORDER-COMMUNITY TRADE-OFFS

01. AFSPA judicial boundary

|

v

02. FMR decision boundary

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not treat every autonomy demand as a Sixth Schedule demand.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read FMR decision and border-community trade-offs as a sequence: identify AFSPA judicial boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not treat every autonomy demand as a Sixth Schedule demand. This keeps AFSPA judicial boundary and FMR decision boundary in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation.
- MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat every autonomy demand as a Sixth Schedule demand.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Distinguish announced policy from notified implementation and livelihood effects.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** AFSPA judicial boundary -> FMR decision boundary
- **Qualified use:** Distinguish announced policy from notified implementation and livelihood effects.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - FMR DECISION AND BORDER-COMMUNITY TRADE-OFFS

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - FMR decision and border-community trade-offs

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS • FMR decision • border-community trade-offs • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • MHA

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Read FMR decision and border-community trade-offs as a sequence: identify AFSPA judicial boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not treat every autonomy demand as a Sixth Schedule demand.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not treat every autonomy demand as a Sixth Schedule demand.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - ASSAM RIFLES MANDATE AND DURABLE PEACE END-STATE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Assam Rifles mandate and durable peace end-state as a sequence: identify Assam-Rifles mandate issue, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Assam-Rifles mandate issue - Peace-process end-state Qualified use: Conclude with reconciliation, accountable security and verified delivery.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Assam Rifles mandate and durable peace end-state as a sequence: identify Assam-Rifles mandate issue, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Assam Rifles mandate
- durable peace end-state
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Subject

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Assam Rifles mandate, connect durable peace end-state with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

ASSAM RIFLES MANDATE AND DURABLE PEACE END-STATE

01. Assam-Rifles mandate issue

|

v

02. Peace-process end-state

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not confuse SoO, framework agreement, settlement and implementation.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Assam Rifles mandate and durable peace end-state as a sequence: identify Assam-Rifles mandate issue, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not confuse SoO, framework agreement, settlement and implementation. This keeps Assam-Rifles mandate issue and Peace-process end-state in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification.
- Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not confuse SoO, framework agreement, settlement and implementation.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Conclude with reconciliation, accountable security and verified delivery.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Assam-Rifles mandate issue -> Peace-process end-state
- **Qualified use:** Conclude with reconciliation, accountable security and verified delivery.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Internal Security | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-III. **Core area:** Historical isolation and identity formation; causes of insurgency; AFSPA debate; identity/migration-driven communal tension; foreign links; the composite peace-process strategy. **Grounded in:** Ashok Kumar Singh, *Challenges to Internal Security of India*, PDF pp. 31-33, 44-50; VisionIAS, *Security Challenges and Their Management in Border Areas*, PDF pp. 24-25; 00_Master - Framework .md Sections 2, 4-5; audited GS-III syllabus; AFSPA 1958 and the Sixth Schedule as published in India Code; MHA Annual Report 2024-25 for accord dates and implementation status. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference | **CURRENT:** = current anchor | **WRONG:** = boundary/trap. **Companion:** advanced/04_North-East - Insurgency - and - Peace - Processes .md.

1. Visual foundation

HISTORICAL ISOLATION

British "excluded area" policy + Christian missionary influence -> minimal contact with India's freedom struggle (Singh, PDF pp. 31-32)

|

v

POST-INDEPENDENCE FRICTION

Sixth Schedule autonomy attempt vs. Assamisation (1960 official-language policy) -> statehood demands

|

v

INSURGENCY DRIVERS

identity/alienation | ethnic proximity across border | porous Myanmar/Bangladesh border | underdevelopment | arms/drug smuggling funding

|

v

STATE RESPONSE (COMPOSITE STRATEGY)

talks/accords + SoO (Suspension of Operations) + development packages + AFSPA (contested) + connectivity

|

v

PEACE-PROCESS MAP

State/faction-specific accords, tracked by date, not treated as one uniform process

Core proposition: FACT: Singh explains that the North-East's tribal population had "a virtual absence of any political, cultural, social, geographical, religious or business contact... with the rest of India," so "India's freedom struggle had very little impact on the tribals" (PDF p.

32. - the historical isolation is the foundational condition for later identity-based insurgency.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Sixth Schedule	Constitutional provision (Articles 244(2) and 275(1)) applying to the tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram, providing "self-rule, autonomy and decentralization" through Autonomous District and Regional Councils with law-making, judicial and revenue powers (Singh, PDF p. 32).
FACT: Suspension of Operations (SoO)	Ceasefire agreements the Government has signed with most North-East insurgent groups (historically "numbering 17-18") as part of a talks-based composite strategy (Singh, PDF p. 44). ANALYSIS: An SoO is a cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules (designated camps, arms in monitored storage, restrictions on movement and extortion), renewable and revocable - it is neither disarmament nor a political settlement.
FACT: AFSPA (Armed Forces Special Powers Act, 1958)	Under Section 3 the Centre or the State Governor may declare an area "disturbed"; Section 4 then confers powers of use of force, arrest without warrant and search without warrant on commissioned/non-commissioned officers; Section 6 bars prosecution of persons acting under the Act except with the previous sanction of the Central Government . Subject to a long-running repeal demand from North-East civil society (Singh, PDF p. 47). ANALYSIS: J&K is covered by a separate statute, the Armed Forces (Jammu and Kashmir) Special Powers Act, 1990.
ANALYSIS: Disturbed-area notification vs. AFSPA repeal	AFSPA applies only where a "disturbed area" notification is in force. Withdrawing or shrinking that notification for districts of a State is an executive act that removes the Act's operation there without repealing the Act. ANALYSIS: MHA has progressively reduced the notified disturbed-area footprint in parts of Nagaland, Assam and Manipur since 2022 - verify the districts currently notified from the latest MHA notification before making any claim, and never equate a reduced footprint with repeal.
FACT: Free Movement Regime (FMR)	A provision allowing tribal communities to travel up to 16 km across the India-Myanmar border without a passport/visa, historically justified by shared ethnicity and cross-border trade (VisionIAS, PDF p. 24). MHA announced its decision to scrap it on 8 February 2024; current operational status requires the latest formal notification.
ANALYSIS: Composite strategy	Singh's term for the Government's combined approach: talks/negotiation with any group abjuring violence, plus strict action against continued violence, plus development and connectivity measures, plus political/structural autonomy tools (PDF p. 44).

3. How the peace-process mechanism works

1. Historical isolation -> post-Independence friction: FACT: British

policy excluded outsiders from tribal areas while permitting Christian missionary access (Singh, PDF p. 31); post-Independence, the 1960 decision to make Assamese "the sole official language" triggered "immediate and strong reaction in the tribal districts," fearing loss of identity through "Assamization" (Singh, PDF p. 32).

2. Statehood fragmentation as accommodation: FACT: The All Party Hill

Leaders Conference (1960) demanded separate statehood; Nagaland (1963), Meghalaya/Manipur/Tripura (1972) and Mizoram (1987) were progressively granted statehood (Singh, PDF pp. 32-33) - a historical accommodation pattern, not a current negotiation.

3. Insurgency drivers: FACT: Singh lists "feeling of alienation and

deprivation," "similar ethnicity across the border on Myanmar side," "porosity of the border," "change in demographic pattern due to infiltration," "disconnect with other parts of India," corruption, "lack of development," easy arms availability and "instability in Myanmar" (PDF p. 44).

4. **Foreign links:** FACT: Myanmar is "the biggest foreign link" for insurgents, given the long, ethnically-linked, difficult-terrain border with Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur and Mizoram (Singh, PDF p. 45); Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan and China have also historically served as transit or shelter points to varying degrees (Singh, PDF pp. 45-46; book-period).

5. **Identity-linked communal/demographic tension:** FACT: The 2012 Bodo-Muslim clashes (Kokrajhar) arose from demographic-change fears tied to migration, and were "vitiating due to circulation of certain provocative SMSs... triggering exodus of North-East people from the southern states" - an early illustration of social media amplifying an identity-linked conflict (Singh, PDF pp. 47-48; developed further in topic 09).

4. Institutions, laws and reference points

- FACT: **Department of Development of North Eastern Region (DoNER):** created 2001, made a full ministry in 2004, focused on regional infrastructure (Singh, PDF p. 45).
- FACT: **North Eastern Council:** established by Act of Parliament in 1971, restructured 2002 as the regional planning body (Singh, PDF p. 45).
- ANALYSIS: **10% Gross Budgetary Support earmarking, Special Category status, Non-Lapsable Central Pool of Resources:** book-period fiscal- devolution mechanisms (Singh, PDF p. 45) - verify current fiscal arrangements from a dated official source.
- CURRENT: **MHA Annual Report 2024-25:** the correct dated source for the present list of signed peace accords/agreements "in the past decade" - required directly by the 2025 PYQ below.

4A. The instrument ladder - and a "past decade" accord map

ANALYSIS: The 2025 PYQ asks candidates to **map** accords, so the first mark is for showing that "peace process" is not one instrument but a ladder of four, each with a different legal effect:

Rung	Instrument	What it actually does	Example
1	Suspension of Operations (SoO) / ceasefire	Stops hostilities on agreed ground rules; cadres in designated camps, arms in monitored storage; renewable and revocable	UPF and KNO SoO, Manipur
2	Framework agreement	Records agreed principles for a future settlement; leaves competencies, territory and timelines open	Framework Agreement with NSCN (IM), 3 August 2015
3	Memorandum of Settlement / accord	A signed settlement with specified commitments - council powers, package, disbandment, rehabilitation	Bodo Accord (27 January 2020); Karbi Anglong Agreement (4 September 2021)
4	Implementation	Statutory/constitutional follow-through - council elections, Sixth Schedule amendment, disbursed package, cadre reintegration	ANALYSIS: The rung on which most criticism falls; must be verified separately, accord by accord

ANALYSIS: **Illustrative "past decade" map (2015-2025).** Each entry below is a publicly announced Government of India agreement; FACT: use the **MHA Annual Report 2024-25** to confirm the exact date, signatories and, critically, the **implementation status** of each before writing it - this file supplies the map, not the status:

- **2015** - Framework Agreement with NSCN (IM) (a framework, WRONG: not a final settlement).
- **2019** - Agreement with NLFT (SD), Tripura.
- **2020** - Bru-Reang permanent-settlement agreement (Tripura); third Bodo Accord with NDFB factions and ABSU.

- **2021** - Karbi Anglong Agreement (Assam).
- **2022** - Assam-Meghalaya inter-State boundary agreement (an *inter-State* boundary settlement, distinct from an insurgent-group accord); agreement with Adivasi/tea-garden-community armed groups (Assam).
- **2023** - Agreement with DNLA (Assam); UNLF agreement (Manipur - the first with a Meitei armed group); Memorandum of Settlement with the pro-talks faction of ULFA (Assam).
- **2024** - Tripartite agreement with TIPRA Motha (Tripura).
- **2025** - Revised ground rules for the tripartite SoO with UPF and KNO

(4 September 2025, valid to 3 September 2026) - CURRENT: a **rung-1** instrument, and therefore evidence that Manipur's process remains at the ceasefire stage rather than the settlement stage.

ANALYSIS: **Pre-decade landmarks worth one line of context:** the Shillong Accord (1975), the Assam Accord (1985), the Mizo Peace Accord (1986 - the standard success case, an insurgency converted into electoral politics) and the Bodoland Territorial Council accord (2003).

WRONG: Do not present a signed accord as a resolved conflict. The Mizo Accord is cited as successful precisely because implementation followed signature; several later accords are contested on exactly that rung.

5. Indian applications and examples

- ANALYSIS: Singh's specific group-membership, leadership and force-level details (e.g. RNHPF, KPLT) are book-period and highly localised; do not present them as current organisational status without separate verification.
- FACT: On AFSPA, Singh takes a calibrated position: acknowledging "at times, security forces are accused of alleged human rights violations," but concluding "the removal of AFSPA now is not advisable" if forces are to operate with meaningful search-and-seizure powers, while stressing forces "must also be wary of human rights violations and must be accountable" (PDF p. 47) - a rights-conscious, not purely security- first, framing.
- ANALYSIS: **AFSPA's judicial boundary:** the Supreme Court upheld AFSPA's constitutionality in *Naga People's Movement of Human Rights v. Union of India* (1997), while making the Army's own "Do's and Don'ts" binding and reading in a proportionality requirement on the use of force; in *Extra Judicial Execution Victim Families Association v. Union of India* (2016) it held that the Act confers no absolute immunity and that allegations of excessive or retaliatory force are open to investigation. ANALYSIS: The exam-usable point: AFSPA's *operational necessity* and its *accountability* are not opposed positions - the Court has affirmed both simultaneously, which is exactly Singh's own framing.
- FACT: Scale of the identity-conflict problem: the 2012 Bodo-Muslim clashes "claimed many lives and displaced more than four lakh people," spreading from Kokrajhar and Chirang across lower Assam (Singh, PDF p. 47) - cite the displacement scale, not casualty figures, since Singh gives the former and not the latter.
- CURRENT: **PYQ mapping - verbatim (2025 Q19):** "What are the major challenges to internal security and peace process in the North-Eastern States? Map the various peace accords and agreements initiated by the government in the past decade."

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: The Sixth Schedule of the Constitution (Articles 244(2) and 275(1)) applies to the tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram, enabling Autonomous District and Regional Councils.
- FACT: Nagaland became a state in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram in 1987; Arunachal Pradesh (formerly NEFA) in 1987.
- FACT: DoNER was created in 2001 and elevated to full ministry status in 2004.

- ANALYSIS: The Free Movement Regime (FMR) with Myanmar, formalised in 2018 as part of the Act East Policy, became the subject of an announced decision to scrap it on 8 February 2024 (VisionIAS, PDF p. 24) - distinguish the policy announcement from independently verified operational status, and do not carry forward the book-period description of the FMR as continuing unchanged.
- FACT: Myanmar is identified as the North-East insurgents' most significant foreign link, owing to shared ethnicity and difficult, porous terrain.
- FACT: AFSPA, 1958: Section 3 (disturbed-area declaration), Section 4 (powers of use of force, arrest and search without warrant), Section 6 (no prosecution without the previous sanction of the Central Government); J&K is covered by the separate Armed Forces (Jammu and Kashmir) Special Powers Act, 1990.
- FACT: *Naga People's Movement of Human Rights v. Union of India* (1997) upheld AFSPA while making the Army's "Do's and Don'ts" binding; *EEVFAM v. Union of India* (2016) held there is no absolute immunity under the Act.
- FACT: The Framework Agreement with NSCN (IM) was signed on 3 August 2015 - a framework, not a final settlement.

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: The North-East is a single, homogeneous insurgency problem. -> Insurgencies vary sharply by State, ethnicity and grievance (Naga, Bodo, Manipuri and other movements each have distinct histories and demands) - avoid treating the region as one undifferentiated bloc.
- WRONG: AFSPA's presence or removal is a settled, one-sided question. -> Singh presents a calibrated, two-sided position: continued utility for search/seizure powers, paired with accountability obligations - a Mains answer should not present only one side.
- WRONG: The 8 February 2024 decision announcement by itself establishes the complete present operational regime. -> State current implementation only from the latest formal MHA/MEA notification.
- WRONG: All North-East insurgent groups are currently active at the levels described in this book. -> Singh's cadre/group counts are book-period; many groups have since signed Suspension of Operations agreements or accords - verify current status from the MHA Annual Report 2024-25 or a subsequent official update.
- WRONG: A signed peace accord means the conflict is resolved. -> Signature and implementation are separate rungs (Section 4A). A framework agreement (NSCN-IM, 2015) records principles; a Memorandum of Settlement records commitments; only verified follow-through - council constituted, package disbursed, cadres reintegrated - evidences resolution.
- WRONG: An SoO agreement is a form of disarmament. -> It is a cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules on camps, arms storage and movement; it is renewable, revocable, and leaves the underlying political demand untouched.
- WRONG: Reducing the notified "disturbed area" footprint amounts to repealing AFSPA. -> AFSPA remains on the statute book; a notification withdrawal under Section 3 simply ends its operation in the de-notified districts, and can be reversed by a fresh notification.
- WRONG: The Sixth Schedule applies to the whole North-East. -> It applies to the tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram; Nagaland's autonomy derives from Article 371A and Manipur's hill areas from Article 371C - different constitutional instruments for different States.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- CURRENT: On **8 February 2024**, MHA announced its decision to scrap the Myanmar Free Movement Regime, reflecting concerns over illegal immigration, the 2023 Manipur ethnic tensions, cross-border misuse by insurgent groups, and a reported surge in narcotics flows from Myanmar (VisionIAS, PDF pp.

24-25). Treat this strictly as an announced decision; current operational status requires a formal notification.

- **CURRENT:** Revised ground rules for the tripartite ****Suspension of Operations**

agreement with UPF and KNO **were signed on 4 September 2025, valid until 3 September 2026****. MHA's April 2026 North-East peace-process update is the current source for accord/status mapping.

10. Mains angles

- **ANALYSIS:** Distinguish "challenges" (identity, borders, development, AFSPA/trust) from "peace accords" (a factual mapping exercise) - the PYQ asks for both, and conflating them loses marks.
- **ANALYSIS:** Use the composite-strategy framing (Section 3) rather than a purely security-centric answer; explicitly cite the Sixth Schedule/autonomy tool as a structural, not merely developmental, response.
- **ANALYSIS:** Where a question touches identity/demographic tension (e.g. the Bodo-Muslim clashes), route the communal/identity dimension through this topic's Section 3.5, not a separate communalism topic (per this folder's design).

11. Probable questions

- **ANALYSIS: Prelims:** Which constitutional schedule provides for autonomous district and regional councils exclusively in the North-East?
- **ANALYSIS: Mains (10 marks):** Explain how historical isolation contributed to identity-based insurgency in India's North-East.
- **ANALYSIS: Mains (15 marks, PYQ-style):** Map the major internal-security challenges and the peace accords initiated by the government in the North-East over the past decade.

12. Core answer architecture - North-East challenges, accords and accountable security

Core firewall: The Core gives the complete 2019 and 2025 answer route. The Advanced companion is optional analytical enrichment only.

Demand decoder and thesis

Thesis: The North-East is a set of identity, autonomy, inter-ethnic, border and governance problems - not one insurgency. Durable peace requires an instrument matched to the named State/faction/demand, with a signed accord kept separate from verified implementation and an AFSPA deployment kept separate from repeal of the statute.

Executable Core spines

15 marks - 2025 challenges and past-decade accord map. Give a one-line regional thesis; map five challenge families (identity/autonomy; inter-ethnic/demographic tension; cross-border sanctuary/trafficking; governance/development; security-legitimacy). Then make a compact, dated instrument map: 2015 NSCN(IM) **Framework**; 2019 NLFT(SD) **agreement**; 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang **settlements**; 2021 Karbi Anglong **agreement**; 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA(pro-talks) **settlements/agreements**; 2024 TIPRA Motha **tripartite agreement**; and the UPF/KNO **SoO** as a ceasefire instrument. For every entry, say its rung and do not claim implementation without a dated MHA status.

15 marks - 2019 India-Myanmar border/insurgency. Start with cross-border ethnic ties, terrain, sanctuary and drug-route vulnerability; compare guarding/regulation with community livelihood costs; map Assam Rifles, ICPs, intelligence and coordinated civil administration; add the 8 February 2024 FMR-scrapping **decision** as an announcement whose operative regime needs a formal notification. Close with lawful mobility and community trust, not fencing alone.

20 marks - AFSPA/accord implementation comparison. Use the ladder SoO -> framework -> settlement -> implementation and balance operational necessity with legality, necessity, proportionality, record/reason, investigation and remedy. A reduction in disturbed-area coverage is an executive notification outcome, not a repeal or a final peace verdict.

Current-status safety notes

- MHA's 2026 AFSPA notifications effective **1 April-30 September 2026**

continued the disturbed-area notification in **nine Nagaland districts plus specified police-station areas**, and in **Tirap, Changlang and Longding districts plus specified Namsai police-station areas** in Arunachal Pradesh. The Manipur notification must be read by its exact police-station exclusions before naming its footprint.

- The revised UPF/KNO tripartite SoO ground rules were signed **4

September 2025 **and stated to run to 3 September 2026****. This is evidence of a rung-1 cessation-of-hostilities arrangement, not a final Manipur settlement.

Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification bank

Claim	Named evidence/example	What it proves	Qualification
Political accommodation can reduce an identity-driven conflict.	Sixth Schedule/statehood history; Bodo and Karbi Anglong agreements.	Autonomy and representation can address a different causal pathway from LW.	An autonomy instrument can generate new inter-group boundary concerns.
Peace instruments have different legal and practical effects.	NSCN(IM) Framework Agreement (2015) versus UPF/KNO SoO (2025).	A map must identify the rung, not count signatures.	Neither framework nor SoO proves disarmament, final settlement or delivery.
AFSPA is an operational-power and accountability question together.	AFSPA sections 3, 4 and 6; <i>Naga People's Movement</i> (1997) and <i>EEVFAM</i> (2016).	Legal authorization, necessity and accountability can be analysed in one answer.	A disturbed-area notification is time-bound and geographically specific; verify it on the answer date.
Border hardening affects border communities.	FMR decision/kinship and small-trade linkages.	Regulation may reduce one misuse channel while imposing livelihood and trust costs.	Do not state an operational abolition without the governing notification.

Direct PYQ routes now owned in Core

- **2019 GS-III:** India-Myanmar border security and North-East insurgency

use the second spine; do not treat FMR as the whole answer.

- **2025 GS-III:** "map" earns marks only when accords, SoOs, framework

agreements and implementation are visibly separated by status.

13. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion:

advanced/04_North-East-Insurgency-and-Peace-Processes.md.

- FACT: 00_Master-Framework.md Sections 2 and 4-5 - the attributes framework

and root-cause/actor-response matrices.

- ANALYSIS: **Lateral topics in this folder:** Topic 06 for the current Myanmar

border-management picture (FMR decision/implementation, ICPs); topic 09 for social- media amplification of identity conflict; topic 12 for Assam Rifles' mandate.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - ASSAM RIFLES MANDATE AND DURABLE PEACE END-STATE

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Assam Rifles mandate and durable peace end-state

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v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Assam Rifles mandate · durable peace end-state · Mechanism chain ·
Qualified use · Subject

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Assam-Rifles mandate issue - Peace-process end-state
Qualified use: Conclude with reconciliation, accountable security and verified delivery.

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v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: ANALYSIS: The 2025 PYQ asks candidates to map accords, so the first mark is for showing that "peace process" is not one instrument but a ladder of four, each with a different legal effect.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: A reduction in disturbed-area coverage is an executive notification outcome, not a repeal or a final peace verdict.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Assam Rifles mandate and durable peace end-state as a sequence: identify Assam-Rifles mandate issue, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

INTERNAL SECURITY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** North-East insurgencies differ by history, territorial demand, ethnic constituency, organisation, state context and negotiating instrument; peace requires security, dialogue, federal accommodation and implementation.
- **Close distinction:** Ceasefire is not final settlement, Suspension of Operations is not disarmament, framework agreement is not concluded accord, accord signature is not implementation, and one group cannot represent every constituency.
- **Mechanism / status / evidence limit:** Name parties, date and legal or political character of each instrument; distinguish talks, agreed text, ratification where relevant, implementation and measured peace outcome.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Historical-isolation condition?

A. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. B. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. C. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. D. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition.

Answer: A. Explanation: British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q2. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Historical-isolation condition?

A. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. B. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. C. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. D. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation.

Answer: B. Explanation: British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q3. Which statement uses Historical-isolation condition without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. B. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. C. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. D. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule.

Answer: C. Explanation: British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Historical-isolation condition?

A. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. B. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. C. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. D. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East.

Answer: D. Explanation: British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Assamisation trigger?

A. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. B. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. C. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. D. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.

Answer: A. Explanation: The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical

condition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q6. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Assamisation trigger?

A. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. B. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. C. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. D. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.

Answer: B. Explanation: The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q7. Which statement uses Assamisation trigger without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. B. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. C. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. D. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assamisation trigger?

A. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. B. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. C. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. D. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition.

Answer: D. Explanation: The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Statehood accommodation?

A. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. B. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. C. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. D. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.

Answer: A. Explanation: Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q10. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Statehood accommodation?

A. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. B. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. C. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. D. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence.

Answer: B. Explanation: Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q11. Which statement uses Statehood accommodation without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. B. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. C. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. D. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Statehood accommodation?

A. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. B. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. C. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. D. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. The

other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Sixth Schedule boundary?

A. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. B. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. C. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. D. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q14. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Sixth Schedule boundary?

A. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. B. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. C. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. D. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q15. Which statement uses Sixth Schedule boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. B. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. C. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. D. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Sixth Schedule boundary?

A. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. B. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. C. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. D. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Articles 371A-371C boundary?

A. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. B. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. C. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. D. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements.

Answer: A. Explanation: Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q18. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Articles 371A-371C boundary?

A. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. B. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. C. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. D. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q19. Which statement uses Articles 371A-371C boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. B. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. C. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. D. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.

Answer: C. Explanation: Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. The

other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Articles 371A-371C boundary?

A. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. B. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. C. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. D. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule.

Answer: D. Explanation: Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Insurgency-driver matrix?

A. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. B. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. C. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. D. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence.

Answer: A. Explanation: Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q22. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Insurgency-driver matrix?

A. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. B. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. C. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. D. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.

Answer: B. Explanation: Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q23. Which statement uses Insurgency-driver matrix without changing its institution, law or status?

A. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. B. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. C. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. D. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Insurgency-driver matrix?

A. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. B. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. C. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. D. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States.

Answer: D. Explanation: Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Myanmar-border linkage?

A. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. B. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. C. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. D. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.

Answer: A. Explanation: Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q26. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Myanmar-border linkage?

A. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. B. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. C. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. D. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q27. Which statement uses Myanmar-border linkage without changing its institution, law or status?

A. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. B. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. C. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. D. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration.

Answer: C. Explanation: Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Myanmar-border linkage?

A. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. B. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. C. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. D. Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Composite strategy?

A. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. B. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. C. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. D. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q30. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Composite strategy?

A. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. B. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. C. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. D. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q31. Which statement uses Composite strategy without changing its institution, law or status?

A. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. B. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. C. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. D. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Composite strategy?

A. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. B. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. C. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. D. The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies SoO boundary?

A. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. B. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. C. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. D. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q34. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of SoO boundary?

A. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. B. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. C. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. D. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q35. Which statement uses SoO boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. B. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. C. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. D. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about SoO boundary?

A. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. B. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. C. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. D. A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Framework-agreement boundary?

A. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. B. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. C. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. D. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration.

Answer: A. Explanation: A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q38. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Framework-agreement boundary?

A. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. B. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. C. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. D. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

Answer: B. Explanation: A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q39. Which statement uses Framework-agreement boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. B. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. C. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. D. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution.

Answer: C. Explanation: A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Framework-agreement boundary?

A. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. B. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. C. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. D. A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.

Answer: D. Explanation: A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Settlement boundary?

A. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. B. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. C. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. D. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q42. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Settlement boundary?

A. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. B. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. C. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. D. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q43. Which statement uses Settlement boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. B. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. C. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. D. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Settlement boundary?

A. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. B. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. C. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. D. A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Implementation boundary?

A. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. B. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. C. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. D. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status.

Answer: A. Explanation: Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q46. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Implementation boundary?

A. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. B. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. C. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. D. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

Answer: B. Explanation: Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q47. Which statement uses Implementation boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. B. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. C. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. D. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Implementation boundary?

A. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. B. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. C. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. D. Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit.

Answer: D. Explanation: Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Past-decade accord map?

A. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. B. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. C. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. D. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q50. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Past-decade accord map?

A. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. B. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. C. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. D. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q51. Which statement uses Past-decade accord map without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. B. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. C. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. D. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Past-decade accord map?

A. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. B. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. C. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. D. The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies UPF-KNO SoO status?

A. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. B. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. C. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. D. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution.

Answer: A. Explanation: Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q54. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of UPF-KNO SoO status?

A. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. B. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. C. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. D. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.

Answer: B. Explanation: Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q55. Which statement uses UPF-KNO SoO status without changing its institution, law or status?

A. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. B. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. C. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. D. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about UPF-KNO SoO status?

A. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. B. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. C. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. D. Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

Answer: D. Explanation: Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies AFSPA sections?

A. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. B. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. C. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. D. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace.

Answer: A. Explanation: Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q58. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of AFSPA sections?

A. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. B. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. C. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. D. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q59. Which statement uses AFSPA sections without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. B. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. C. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. D. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.

Answer: C. Explanation: Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about AFSPA sections?

A. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. B. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. C. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. D. Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution.

Answer: D. Explanation: Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Notification-repeal firewall?

A. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. B. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. C. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. D. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q62. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Notification-repeal firewall?

A. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. B. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. C. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. D. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone.

Answer: B. Explanation: Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q63. Which statement uses Notification-repeal firewall without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. B. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. C. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. D. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East.

Answer: C. Explanation: Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Notification-repeal firewall?

A. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. B. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. C. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. D. Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace.

Answer: D. Explanation: Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. The other

options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies AFSPA judicial boundary?

A. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. B. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. C. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. D. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.

Answer: A. Explanation: Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q66. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of AFSPA judicial boundary?

A. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. B. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. C. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. D. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification.

Answer: B. Explanation: Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q67. Which statement uses AFSPA judicial boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. B. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. C. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. D. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East.

Answer: C. Explanation: Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about AFSPA judicial boundary?

A. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. B. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. C. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. D. Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies FMR decision boundary?

A. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. B. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. C. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. D. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone.

Answer: A. Explanation: MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q70. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of FMR decision boundary?

A. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. B. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. C. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. D. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone.

Answer: B. Explanation: MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q71. Which statement uses FMR decision boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. B. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. C. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. D. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition.

Answer: C. Explanation: MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the

governing notification. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about FMR decision boundary?

A. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. B. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. C. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. D. MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.

Answer: D. Explanation: MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Assam-Rifles mandate issue?

A. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. B. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. C. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. D. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q74. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Assam-Rifles mandate issue?

A. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. B. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. C. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. D. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q75. Which statement uses Assam-Rifles mandate issue without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. B. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. C. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. D. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assam-Rifles mandate issue?

A. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. B. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. C. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. D. The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Peace-process end-state?

A. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. B. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. C. British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. D. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q78. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Peace-process end-state?

A. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. B. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. C. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. D. The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition.

Answer: B. Explanation: Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q79. Which statement uses Peace-process end-state without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. B. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. C. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. D. Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Peace-process end-state?

A. Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. B. Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. C. The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. D. Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone.

Answer: D. Explanation: Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

AUDITED TOPIC-SPECIFIC PYQ OWNERSHIP

The audited GS-III ledgers route the 2019 India-Myanmar-border demand and the 2025 North-East challenges-and-accord-map demand here. Every instrument retains its date, State or faction and legal/status rung; signature is never rewritten as implementation.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III

Demand: India-Myanmar border security challenges and their connection with insurgency in the North-East.

Status: Audited neutral rendering; Examine · 15 marks · 250 words.

Model solution: Insurgency-driver matrix: Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Myanmar-border linkage:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. **Composite strategy:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **FMR decision boundary:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. **Assam-Rifles mandate issue:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. **Peace-process end-state:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without

inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Insurgency-driver matrix: Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Myanmar-border linkage:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. **Composite strategy:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **FMR decision boundary:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. **Assam-Rifles mandate issue:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. **Peace-process end-state:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Demand: India-Myanmar border security challenges and their connection with insurgency in the North-East. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Status: Audited neutral rendering; Examine · 15 marks · 250 words. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Insurgency-driver matrix: Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Myanmar-border linkage:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. **Composite strategy:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **FMR decision boundary:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. **Assam-Rifles mandate issue:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. **Peace-process end-state:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points;

reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 GS-III

Demand: "What are the major challenges to internal security and peace process in the North-Eastern States? Map the various peace accords and agreements initiated by the government in the past decade."

Status: Verbatim owner-preserved question; Map · 15 marks · 250 words.

Model solution: Historical-isolation condition: British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East.

Sixth Schedule boundary: The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Articles 371A-371C boundary:** Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule.

Insurgency-driver matrix: Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Myanmar-border linkage:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. **SoO boundary:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

Framework-agreement boundary: A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Settlement boundary:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Implementation boundary:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit.

Past-decade accord map: The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. **UPF-KNO SoO status:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **AFSPA sections:** Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. **Notification-repeal firewall:** Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace.

Peace-process end-state: Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 GS-III', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Historical-isolation condition: British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. **Sixth Schedule boundary:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Articles 371A-371C boundary:** Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth

Schedule. **Insurgency-driver matrix:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Myanmar-border linkage:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. **SoO boundary:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.

Framework-agreement boundary: A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Settlement boundary:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Implementation boundary:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit.

Past-decade accord map: The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. **UPF-KNO SoO status:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **AFSPA sections:** Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. **Notification-repeal firewall:** Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace.

Peace-process end-state: Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Demand: "What are the major challenges to internal security and peace process in the North-Eastern States? Map the various peace accords and agreements initiated by the government in the past decade." **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Status: Verbatim owner-preserved question; Map · 15 marks · 250 words. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Historical-isolation condition: British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. **Sixth Schedule boundary:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Articles 371A-371C boundary:** Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule. **Insurgency-driver matrix:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Myanmar-border linkage:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. **SoO boundary:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Framework-agreement boundary:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but

leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Settlement boundary:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Implementation boundary:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Past-decade accord map:** The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. **UPF-KNO SoO status:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **AFSPA sections:** Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. **Notification-repeal firewall:** Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. **Peace-process end-state:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 GS-III', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain how historical isolation and identity formation contributed to insurgency in the North-East. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Historical-isolation condition. **Named evidence/example:** British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Assamisation trigger. **Named evidence/example:** The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Statehood accommodation. **Named evidence/example:** Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sixth Schedule boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument,

institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East.
- The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition.
- Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation.
- The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.
- Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Historical-isolation condition. **Named evidence/example:** British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Assamisation trigger. **Named evidence/example:** The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Statehood accommodation. **Named evidence/example:** Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sixth Schedule boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on 'Explain how historical isolation and identity formation contributed to insurgency in the...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Historical-isolation condition. **Named evidence/example:** British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Assamisation trigger. **Named evidence/example:** The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal

character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Statehood accommodation. **Named evidence/example:** Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sixth Schedule boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Historical-isolation condition. **Named evidence/example:** British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Assamisation trigger. **Named evidence/example:** The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Statehood accommodation. **Named evidence/example:** Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sixth Schedule boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Explain how historical isolation and identity formation contributed to insurgency in the...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish a Suspension of Operations agreement from a political settlement and implementation. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: SoO boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Framework-agreement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Settlement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and

notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Implementation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UPF-KNO SoO status. **Named evidence/example:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.
- A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.
- A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration.
- Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit.
- Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** SoO boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Framework-agreement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Settlement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Implementation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UPF-KNO SoO status. **Named evidence/example:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'Distinguish a Suspension of Operations agreement from a political settlement and...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** SoO boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a

final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Framework-agreement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Settlement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Implementation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UPF-KNO SoO status. **Named evidence/example:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response

route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: SoO boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Framework-agreement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Settlement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Implementation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UPF-KNO SoO status. **Named evidence/example:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Distinguish a Suspension of Operations agreement from a political settlement and...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine India-Myanmar border-security challenges and their links with North-East insurgency. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Myanmar-border linkage. **Named evidence/example:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date,

institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Composite strategy. **Named evidence/example:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** FMR decision boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Assam-Rifles mandate issue. **Named evidence/example:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Peace-process end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States.
- Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence.
- The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements.
- MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.
- The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification.
- Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Myanmar-border linkage. **Named evidence/example:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Composite strategy. **Named evidence/example:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** FMR decision boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy

implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Assam-Rifles mandate issue. **Named evidence/example:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Peace-process end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on 'Examine India-Myanmar border-security challenges and their links with North-East insurgency....', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Myanmar-border linkage. **Named evidence/example:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Composite strategy. **Named evidence/example:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** FMR decision boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Assam-Rifles mandate issue. **Named evidence/example:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Peace-process end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

2. **Claim:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
6. **Claim:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Myanmar-border linkage. **Named evidence/example:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Composite strategy. **Named evidence/example:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** FMR decision boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and

notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Assam-Rifles mandate issue. **Named evidence/example:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Peace-process end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Examine India-Myanmar border-security challenges and their links with North-East insurgency....', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Map the major internal-security challenges and peace instruments in the North-East over the past decade. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Sixth Schedule boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Composite strategy. **Named evidence/example:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** SoO boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Framework-agreement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Settlement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Implementation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Past-decade accord map. **Named evidence/example:** The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UPF-KNO SoO status. **Named evidence/example:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.
- Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States.
- The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements.
- A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.
- A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.
- A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration.
- Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit.
- The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status.
- Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Sixth Schedule boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Composite strategy. **Named evidence/example:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** SoO boundary. **Named**

evidence/example: A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Framework-agreement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Settlement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Implementation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Past-decade accord map. **Named evidence/example:** The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UPF-KNO SoO status. **Named evidence/example:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'Map the major internal-security challenges and peace instruments in the North-East over the...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Sixth Schedule boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Composite strategy. **Named evidence/example:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** SoO boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and

notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Framework-agreement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Settlement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Implementation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Past-decade accord map. **Named evidence/example:** The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UPF-KNO SoO status. **Named evidence/example:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

5. **Claim:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
6. **Claim:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
7. **Claim:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
8. **Claim:** The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
9. **Claim:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Sixth Schedule boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Insurgency-driver matrix. **Named evidence/example:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Composite strategy. **Named evidence/example:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** SoO boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the

policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Framework-agreement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Settlement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Implementation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Past-decade accord map. **Named evidence/example:** The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UPF-KNO SoO status. **Named evidence/example:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Map the major internal-security challenges and peace instruments in the North-East over the...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Critically evaluate AFSPA's operational necessity and accountability architecture in the North-East. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** AFSPA sections. **Named evidence/example:** Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Notification-repeal firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** AFSPA judicial boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. **Analysis:** This

fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Peace-process end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution.
- Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace.
- Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation.
- Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** AFSPA sections. **Named evidence/example:** Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Notification-repeal firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** AFSPA judicial boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Peace-process end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on 'Critically evaluate AFSPA's operational necessity and accountability architecture in the...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** AFSPA sections. **Named evidence/example:** Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Notification-repeal firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** AFSPA judicial boundary. **Named**

evidence/example: Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Peace-process end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** AFSPA sections. **Named evidence/example:** Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Notification-repeal firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** AFSPA judicial boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and

notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Peace-process end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Critically evaluate AFSPA's operational necessity and accountability architecture in the...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess whether the North-East peace process has moved from accords to durable implementation and inter-ethnic reconciliation. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Statehood accommodation. **Named evidence/example:** Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sixth Schedule boundary.

Named evidence/example: The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Composite strategy. **Named evidence/example:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** SoO boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Framework-agreement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Settlement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Implementation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and

notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Past-decade accord map. **Named evidence/example:** The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UPF-KNO SoO status. **Named evidence/example:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** FMR decision boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Assam-Rifles mandate issue. **Named evidence/example:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Peace-process end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation.
- The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.
- The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements.
- A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.
- A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.
- A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration.
- Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit.
- The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status.
- Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.
- MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.
- The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification.

- Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Statehood accommodation. **Named evidence/example:** Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Sixth Schedule boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Composite strategy. **Named evidence/example:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** SoO boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Framework-agreement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Settlement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Implementation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Past-decade accord map. **Named evidence/example:** The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UPF-KNO SoO status. **Named evidence/example:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** FMR decision boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Assam-Rifles mandate issue. **Named evidence/example:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat

category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Peace-process end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on 'Assess whether the North-East peace process has moved from accords to durable implementation...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Statehood accommodation. **Named evidence/example:** Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Sixth Schedule boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Composite strategy. **Named evidence/example:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** SoO boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Framework-agreement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

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Claim: Implementation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Past-decade accord map. **Named evidence/example:** The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: UPF-KNO SoO status. **Named evidence/example:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** FMR decision boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Assam-Rifles mandate issue. **Named evidence/example:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Peace-process end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
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9. **Claim:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
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12. **Claim:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Statehood accommodation. **Named evidence/example:** Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sixth Schedule boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The

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Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Assess whether the North-East peace process has moved from accords to durable implementation...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Internal Security | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-III. **Core area:** State/faction-specific accord mapping; the AFSPA rights- versus-operational-necessity trade-off; the 2024 decision to scrap the FMR as a case study in border-insurgency-identity interaction; inter-ethnic reconciliation design. **Grounded in:** Ashok Kumar Singh, *Challenges to Internal Security of India*, PDF pp. 44-50; VisionIAS, *Security Challenges and Their Management in Border Areas*, PDF pp. 24-25; 00_Master - Framework .md Sections 5-9; audited GS-III syllabus; AFSPA 1958, Articles 244(2), 371A and 371C as published in India Code; *Naga People's Movement of Human Rights* (1997) and *EEVFAM* (2016). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current anchor | **WRONG:** = boundary/trap. *Companion:* basic/04_North-East-Insurgency-and-Peace-Processes .md.

1. Answer thesis and syllabus boundary

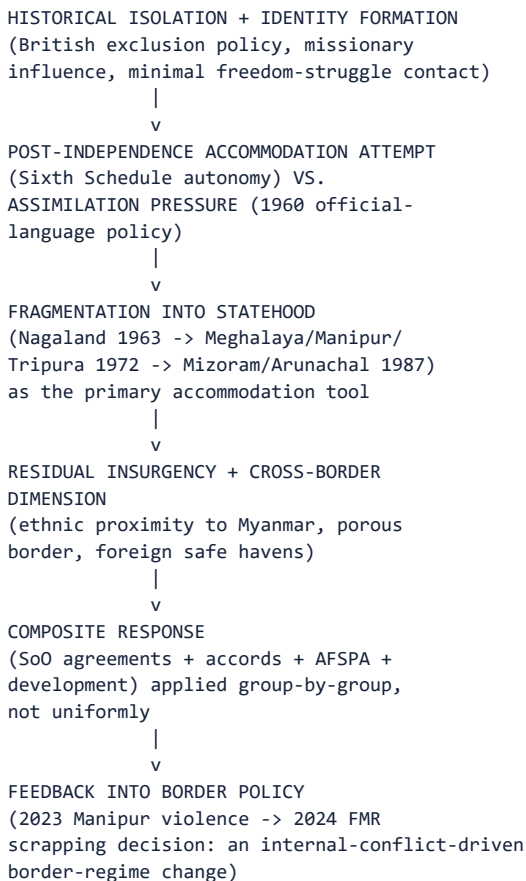
Thesis: ANALYSIS: The North-East's peace-process record shows that accommodation (statehood, Sixth Schedule autonomy, SoO agreements) has been the durable long-run tool, while coercive measures (AFSPA) remain necessary but must be continuously rights-audited to avoid reproducing the very alienation the accommodation track is designed to resolve - the 8 February 2024 decision to scrap the Free Movement Regime is a recent illustration of how a border-management decision can be forced by an internal identity conflict (2023 Manipur violence), not the reverse.

Boundary: WRONG: this topic does not answer a generic Bangladesh/Nepal border question (topic 06) in place of a peace-process answer, per this folder's explicit design.

2. Conceptual distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
FACT: Accommodation vs. coercion as parallel, not sequential, tracks	Singh's composite strategy (basic topic Section 3) runs talks/accords and strict security action simultaneously, calibrated by which specific faction/group is engaging in each - not "first coerce, then accommodate."
ANALYSIS: Identity-driven vs. resource-driven insurgency	North-East insurgency is predominantly identity/autonomy-driven (unlike LWE's resource/land-driven pattern), which is why the primary durable tool has been political-structural (Sixth Schedule, statehood, autonomous councils) rather than purely socio-economic development.
FACT: AFSPA's operational-necessity argument, precisely stated	FACT: Singh: "If the armed forces are deployed without the power of search and seizure, then their deployment is meaningless" (PDF p. 47) - the argument is functional (a deployed force needs enabling powers), not merely political.
FACT: AFSPA's accountability counter-argument, precisely stated	FACT: Singh, in the same passage: forces "must also be wary of human rights violations and must be accountable for their actions and behaviour towards the public" (PDF p. 47) - the two arguments are presented together, not as opposing camps to pick one from.
ANALYSIS: Border regime as an internal-security-dependent variable	The 8 February 2024 decision to scrap the FMR shows a cross-border regime being reconsidered partly because of internal ethnic conflict and insurgent misuse, not only external diplomacy. Current implementation must be sourced separately.
ANALYSIS: The four-rung instrument ladder, and why the rung determines the argument	Ceasefire/SoO -> framework agreement -> Memorandum of Settlement -> implementation (basic companion, Section 4A). ANALYSIS: The analytical payoff: the <i>same</i> State can occupy different rungs simultaneously - Nagaland has held a framework agreement since 2015 without a final settlement, Assam has multiple signed settlements at varying implementation stages, and Manipur's principal live instrument remains a rung-1 SoO. "Progress in the North-East" is therefore not one trend line but several, and a Mains answer that says so is doing the mapping the 2025 PYQ actually asks for.
ANALYSIS: Autonomy instruments are not interchangeable	The Sixth Schedule (Articles 244(2)/275(1)) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram; Nagaland's protections run through Article 371A (customary law, land and resources, requiring Assembly concurrence for named central laws) and Manipur's hill areas through Article 371C . ANALYSIS: This matters operationally: a demand framed as "Sixth Schedule status" (as in Ladakh's or some Manipur hill demands) is a demand for a <i>different</i> constitutional instrument, not merely more funds - and accords that promise autonomy must specify which instrument they intend.

3. Causal model



Analytical claim: ANALYSIS: The 2024 decision to scrap the FMR is an available case of the causal arrow running from internal identity conflict to border-policy change, rather than the more commonly assumed reverse (porous border causing insurgency) - VisionIAS records the decision's reasons as illegal immigration and demographic change, the 2023 Manipur Meitei-Kuki tensions, exodus of Myanmar junta soldiers into Mizoram, and a UNODC-linked surge in narcotics flow from Myanmar's post-coup turmoil (PDF pp. 24-25) - a compound, not single-cause, decision.

4. Institutional and reform architecture

- **FACT: Suspension of Operations (SoO) framework:** the standard mechanism

for transitioning an armed group toward talks without requiring immediate full disarmament - Singh notes SoO agreements historically covered "most of the insurgent groups (numbering 17-18)" (PDF p. 44, book-period count). ANALYSIS: Its design weakness is structural: ground rules (camp confinement, arms in monitored storage, no extortion) require continuous monitoring capacity, so an SoO's value depends on the monitoring mechanism, not on the signature.

- **ANALYSIS: Assam Rifles' dual and contested mandate:** VisionIAS records that

Assam Rifles "mans this border since 2002 with some help from Indian Army," and has deployed the larger share of its battalions to counter- insurgency duties rather than pure border guarding along the Myanmar border (31 of 46 battalions to counter-insurgency versus 15 to border guarding, per the source's figures) - "functioning more like a counter-insurgency force rather than a border guarding force" (PDF p. 25). **FACT:** The same source's "way ahead" is explicit: either give Assam Rifles "the single mandate of guarding the border" or deploy another border-guarding force such as the BSF - a live "one force, one mandate" institutional design question connecting this topic to topic 06 and topic 12.

- **ANALYSIS: Article 356 as the residual instrument:** where a State's

law-and-order machinery is assessed to have failed, the Union's options escalate from central-force deployment under Union List Entry 2A (aid to the civil power, State government intact) to President's Rule under Article 356 (State executive superseded). ANALYSIS: Manipur's situation since the 2023 ethnic violence has drawn on both instruments - verify the State's **current** constitutional status from the Gazette/MHA before asserting it, since President's Rule is time-bound and reversible.

- ANALYSIS: **AFSPA's judicial frame as the accountability instrument:**

Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld the Act while making the Army's "Do's and Don'ts" binding and requiring minimum necessary force; *EEVFAM* (2016) held there is no absolute immunity and that alleged excesses are investigable. ANALYSIS: Section 6's central-sanction requirement remains the practical bottleneck between an investigation and a prosecution - the precise point at which "accountability exists in law" and "accountability operates in practice" diverge.

- CURRENT: **Current-anchor institutional detail:** the precise, current list of peace accords "in the past decade" (directly required by the 2025 PYQ) must be built from the MHA Annual Report 2024-25's dated entries, not from this book's older accord references.

- ANALYSIS: ****Vibrant Villages Programme (2022) and similar border-village schemes:**** while primarily framed as border infrastructure (topic 06), they also function as an accommodation/development tool reducing alienation in North-East border districts - a cross-cutting institution worth citing in a peace-process answer.

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- ANALYSIS: **Bodo-Muslim 2012 clashes as an identity-migration boundary case:**

Singh's account shows demographic-change fear (attributed to Bangladesh-origin migration) combining with social-media-amplified rumour to produce large-scale displacement and a wider exodus panic in southern Indian cities (PDF pp. 47-48) - illustrates how an identity conflict in one State can generate a national-level information-warfare effect (cross-reference topic 09), without this folder needing a separate "communalism" topic.

- ANALYSIS: **AFSPA's Irom Sharmila protest as a legitimacy boundary case:**

Singh cites her decade-long hunger strike as evidence of the depth of grievance against AFSPA (PDF p. 47) - a reusable illustration of the accountability-legitimacy stakes in any AFSPA-related answer, without taking a one-sided position.

- ANALYSIS: ****The 2024 FMR-scrapping decision as a boundary case between IR and Internal Security:**** IR would analyse India-Myanmar diplomatic engagement around the decision; this folder analyses its domestic operational effect (reduced cross-border misuse channel for insurgents, but also disrupted legitimate small-scale cross-border trade/kinship contact) - a clean illustration of the two subjects' boundary.

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- ANALYSIS: ****Statehood/autonomy accommodation resolves group-level demands but can create new inter-ethnic friction**** (e.g., hill-versus-plains or tribal-versus-non-tribal tension within a newly autonomous unit) - accommodation is not costless or final.

- ANALYSIS: ****SoO agreements manage violence but do not by themselves resolve underlying political demands****; prolonged SoO status without a political settlement can itself become a source of frustration and fragmentation within a group. ANALYSIS: The converse risk is equally real: a signed settlement whose implementation stalls converts a negotiating partner into an aggrieved one, which is why the implementation rung (basic companion, Section 4A) carries more analytical weight than the number of accords signed.

- ANALYSIS: ****Accommodation of one group can re-open a boundary question with another.**** An accord conferring territorial or council-level autonomy on one community necessarily fixes a boundary that a neighbouring community may contest - the structural reason North-East settlements tend to generate successor demands rather than closing the file.

- ANALYSIS: ****AFSPA's operational-necessity and accountability arguments are in permanent tension****, not a problem solvable by policy design alone - continuous, transparent accountability mechanisms are the only way to sustain both simultaneously, and Section 6's central-sanction requirement is where that tension is actually adjudicated.

- WRONG: ****The 2024 FMR-scrapping decision is not a comprehensive solution to Myanmar-border insurgency and narcotics flow**** - VisionIAS's own "way ahead" notes continuing need for a single-mandate border force, expedited Integrated Check Post infrastructure and renewed engagement with Myanmar (PDF p. 25);

treat it as one measure among several, not a closing move.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: Assam Rifles has historically deployed a larger share of its battalions to counter-insurgency duties than to pure border-guarding duties along the India-Myanmar border (per VisionIAS's cited figures).

- FACT: The 8 February 2024 decision to scrap the Free Movement Regime was attributed to illegal immigration/demographic change concerns, the 2023 Manipur ethnic tensions, Myanmar junta-soldier exodus into Mizoram, and a reported narcotics-flow surge from Myanmar.

- FACT: Suspension of Operations (SoO) is the standard mechanism for managing an armed group's transition toward political talks without requiring immediate disarmament.

- FACT: Singh's AFSPA position is explicitly two-sided: operational necessity (search/seizure powers) paired with an accountability obligation, not a one-sided endorsement - a position the Supreme Court's 1997 and 2016 rulings mirror (constitutionality upheld; no absolute immunity).

- FACT: AFSPA Section 3 governs the disturbed-area declaration, Section 4 the powers conferred, and Section 6 the requirement of prior Central Government sanction before prosecution.

- FACT: VisionIAS's own "way ahead" recommends either giving Assam Rifles the single mandate of border guarding or deploying another border-guarding force such as the BSF on the Myanmar border.

- FACT: Nagaland's constitutional protection runs through Article 371A and Manipur's hill areas through Article 371C - not the Sixth Schedule, which covers tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: The 2024 FMR-scrapping decision was primarily a diplomatic/IR decision toward Myanmar. -> VisionIAS frames it as driven by domestic identity-conflict and internal-security concerns (Manipur violence, insurgent misuse, narcotics flow) - an internal-security-owned decision with external operational effect, not the reverse.

- WRONG: Assam Rifles' primary current function along the Myanmar border is border guarding. -> The cited battalion-deployment split shows it functions predominantly as a counter-insurgency force in practice, a "one force, one mandate" institutional gap.

- WRONG: SoO agreements amount to full disarmament or conflict resolution. -> They are ceasefire/dialogue-enabling arrangements; the underlying political demand still requires a separate negotiated settlement.

- WRONG: The 2015 Framework Agreement with NSCN (IM) is a final Naga settlement. -> It records agreed principles; competencies, territory and timelines were left to later negotiation, which is precisely why the process remains open.

- WRONG: AFSPA gives security forces absolute immunity from prosecution. -> The Supreme Court held in *EEVFAM* (2016) that there is no absolute immunity; Section 6 requires prior Central Government sanction, which is a procedural filter, not a bar on investigation.

9. CURRENT: Current-anchor note

- CURRENT: MHA announced its decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime on **8 February 2024**; do not convert the announcement into operational status without a formal notification.

- CURRENT: Revised UPF/KNO Suspension of Operations ground rules were signed on **4 September 2025** and remain valid through **3 September 2026**. Use MHA's **23 April 2026 North-East peace-process update** for the current accord map required by the 2025 PYQ, not the book's older list.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: The North-East's peace process demonstrates that political-structural accommodation (statehood, Sixth Schedule, SoO agreements) has been the primary durable tool for an identity-driven insurgency, while coercive instruments (AFSPA) remain operationally necessary but require continuous, transparent accountability to avoid reproducing the alienation that first fuelled the insurgency - a lesson most recently visible in how the 2023 Manipur conflict forced the 2024 Myanmar border-regime change.

1. **Trace the historical-isolation-to-fragmentation causal chain** (Section 3).
2. **Distinguish identity-driven insurgency from resource-driven LWE**, explaining why political-structural tools dominate the response here.
3. **Present AFSPA's two-sided argument** exactly as Singh frames it - operational necessity paired with accountability - without picking a one-sided stance.
4. **Cite the 2024 FMR-scrapping decision**, dated and reasoned, as a recent case of internal conflict driving border policy.
5. **Name the Assam Rifles single-mandate gap** as a live institutional challenge.
6. **Build the "past decade" accord map** strictly from the current MHA Annual Report.
7. ****Close by relating the peace process back to the master framework's coercion/accommodation distinction**** (Section 1 of 00_Master - Framework.md).

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** In what year was the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime formalised, and on what date did MHA announce the decision to scrap it?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks, PYQ-linked):** Map the North-East's internal-security challenges and the peace accords of the past decade, distinguishing accommodation from coercive instruments in the government's approach.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "Signing an accord and settling a conflict are different achievements." Examine with reference to the North-East peace process of the past decade.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "The 2024 decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime illustrates how internal identity conflict can reshape border policy." Discuss.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: `basic/04_North-East-Insurgency-and-Peace-Processes.md`.
- FACT: `00_Master-Framework.md` Sections 5, 6 and 8 - the actor-response matrix, federal architecture and recurring analytical gaps.
- FACT: `06_Border-Management-and-Border-Area-Development` (basic and advanced) - the current India-Myanmar border-management picture, Integrated Check Posts and BADP/BIM detail.
- ANALYSIS: **Lateral topics in this folder:** Topic 09 for the social-media amplification dimension of identity conflict; topic 12 for the Assam Rifles mandate question in full institutional detail.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

North-East Insurgency and Peace Processes: IDENTITY, AUTONOMY AND CROSS-BORDER CHALLENGE MAP

1. **Historical-isolation condition:** British excluded-area policy, limited links with the wider freedom struggle and distinct missionary and administrative experiences shaped later identity and alienation in the North-East.
2. **Assamisation trigger:** The 1960 Assamese official-language decision generated strong tribal-district resistance and fear of identity loss, illustrating how a proximate policy trigger can activate a deeper historical condition.
3. **Statehood accommodation:** Nagaland became a State in 1963; Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura in 1972; Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh in 1987, showing political accommodation through territorial reorganisation.
4. **Sixth Schedule boundary:** The Sixth Schedule under Articles 244(2) and 275(1) applies to tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram through Autonomous District and Regional Councils; it does not cover the entire North-East.
5. **Articles 371A-371C boundary:** Nagaland's special constitutional protection operates through Article 371A, while Manipur's hill-area mechanism is linked to Article 371C; these are not substitutes for the Sixth Schedule.
6. **Insurgency-driver matrix:** Identity and autonomy claims, inter-ethnic tension, demographic anxieties, underdevelopment, weak governance, difficult terrain, arms or narcotics routes and cross-border sanctuary interact differently across States.
7. **Myanmar-border linkage:** Shared ethnic ties, terrain and cross-border movement make Myanmar a major external linkage for North-East insurgency; current sanctuary or group claims require dated official evidence.
8. **Composite strategy:** The Government's composite approach combines talks with groups abjuring violence, lawful action against continuing violence, development and connectivity, and political or autonomy arrangements.
9. **SoO boundary:** A Suspension of Operations agreement is a renewable, revocable cessation-of-hostilities arrangement with ground rules; it is not disarmament, a final political settlement or verified rehabilitation.
10. **Framework-agreement boundary:** A framework agreement records agreed principles for future negotiation but leaves competencies, territory or implementation open; the NSCN (IM) Framework Agreement of 3 August 2015 is not a final settlement.
11. **Settlement boundary:** A Memorandum of Settlement or accord records specified commitments, but signature alone does not prove council formation, legal amendment, package disbursement, disbandment or reintegration.
12. **Implementation boundary:** Implementation is the separate rung where constitutional, statutory, financial and rehabilitation commitments are verified; accord counts cannot substitute for an implementation audit.
13. **Past-decade accord map:** The owner maps the 2019 NLFT(SD), 2020 Bodo and Bru-Reang, 2021 Karbi Anglong, 2022 boundary and Adivasi-group, 2023 DNLA, UNLF and ULFA pro-talks, and 2024 TIPRA Motha instruments, each requiring exact status.
14. **UPF-KNO SoO status:** Revised tripartite Suspension of Operations ground rules with UPF and KNO were signed on 4 September 2025 and stated to run through 3 September 2026; this is a ceasefire rung, not a Manipur settlement.
15. **AFSPA sections:** Under AFSPA 1958, section 3 governs disturbed-area declaration, section 4 confers specified powers in a notified area, and section 6 requires previous Central Government sanction before prosecution.
16. **Notification-repeal firewall:** Shrinking or withdrawing a disturbed-area notification ends AFSPA's operation only in the de-notified area for that notification period; it neither repeals the Act nor proves final peace.
17. **AFSPA judicial boundary:** Naga People's Movement of Human Rights (1997) upheld AFSPA with binding safeguards, while EEVFAM (2016) rejected absolute immunity and kept alleged excessive force open to investigation.
18. **FMR decision boundary:** MHA announced on 8 February 2024 a decision to scrap the India-Myanmar Free Movement Regime; an announcement must not be stated as the complete operational regime without the governing notification.

19. **Assam-Rifles mandate issue:** The owner identifies a border-guarding versus counter-insurgency mandate tension for Assam Rifles along the Myanmar border; current deployments and force numbers require dated official verification.
20. **Peace-process end-state:** Durable peace requires State- and faction-specific accommodation, lawful and accountable security, inter-ethnic reconciliation, border governance and verified implementation rather than signatures alone.

North-East Insurgency and Peace Processes: **PEACE-INSTRUMENT LADDER AND PAST-DECADE ACCORD MAP**

- Do not treat the North-East as one homogeneous insurgency.
- Do not treat every autonomy demand as a Sixth Schedule demand.
- Do not confuse SoO, framework agreement, settlement and implementation.
- Do not call an SoO disarmament or rehabilitation.
- Do not call the 2015 Framework Agreement a final Naga settlement.
- Do not treat accord signature as implemented peace.
- Do not equate reduced disturbed-area coverage with AFSPA repeal.
- Do not describe AFSPA as absolute immunity.
- Do not convert the 2024 FMR decision into operational abolition without notification.
- Do not carry book-period group strength or status into the present.
- Do not use border hardening as the only peace-process answer.
- Do not publish tactical camp, movement or force-deployment detail.

North-East Insurgency and Peace Processes: **AFSPA, BORDER GOVERNANCE AND ANSWER-WRITING SPINE**

BEGIN WITH STATE-SPECIFIC IDENTITY AUTONOMY BORDER AND GOVERNANCE PATHWAYS
-> NAME THE CORRECT SIXTH-SCHEDULE OR ARTICLE 371 INSTRUMENT
-> SEPARATE SOO FRAMEWORK SETTLEMENT AND IMPLEMENTATION
-> MAP DATE STATE FACTION AND INSTRUMENT FOR EVERY ACCORD
-> BALANCE AFSPA NECESSITY WITH SAFEGUARDS INVESTIGATION AND REMEDY
-> GRADE FMR DECISION AND DISTURBED-AREA NOTIFICATION PRECISELY
-> ADDRESS ASSAM RIFLES MANDATE AND BORDER-COMMUNITY COSTS
-> CONCLUDE ON RECONCILIATION ACCOUNTABLE SECURITY AND VERIFIED DELIVERY

North-East Insurgency and Peace Processes: **NOTIFICATION, IMPLEMENTATION AND DURABLE-PEACE FIREWALL**

The current anchors are notification- and instrument-specific: the 8 February 2024 FMR decision remains an announcement unless supported by an operative notification; the 4 September 2025 UPF/KNO instrument remains an SoO; and 2026 disturbed-area notifications do not repeal AFSPA.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Isolation-to-identity chain

EXCLUDED-AREA GOVERNANCE + LIMITED WIDER CONTACT
-> DISTINCT IDENTITY AND POLITICAL EXPERIENCE
-> POST-INDEPENDENCE ASSIMILATION FEAR
-> AUTONOMY / STATEHOOD DEMANDS

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Statehood timeline

1963 -> NAGALAND
1972 -> MEGHALAYA / MANIPUR / TRIPURA
1987 -> MIZORAM / ARUNACHAL PRADESH
LESSON -> political accommodation can change conflict incentives

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Autonomy instrument map

SIXTH SCHEDULE -> Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram tribal areas
ARTICLE 371A -> Nagaland
ARTICLE 371C -> Manipur hill-area mechanism
RULE -> autonomy instruments are not interchangeable

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Challenge matrix

IDENTITY / AUTONOMY | INTER-ETHNIC TENSION
BORDER / SANCTUARY | ARMS / NARCOTICS ROUTES
UNDERDEVELOPMENT | GOVERNANCE / TRUST DEFICIT
ANSWER -> identify State, actor and dominant pathway

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Composite response system

TALKS / ACCORDS -> accommodation
LAWFUL SECURITY -> contain continuing violence
DEVELOPMENT / CONNECTIVITY -> reduce isolation
AUTONOMY / REPRESENTATION -> political end-state

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Peace-instrument ladder

1 SOO / CEASEFIRE
2 FRAMEWORK AGREEMENT
3 MEMORANDUM OF SETTLEMENT / ACCORD
4 VERIFIED IMPLEMENTATION
RULE -> each rung proves only itself

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Accord map 2015-2020

2015 NSCN(IM) -> FRAMEWORK
2019 NLFT(SD) -> AGREEMENT
2020 BODO -> SETTLEMENT
2020 BRU-REANG -> PERMANENT-SETTLEMENT AGREEMENT

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Accord map 2021-2024

2021 KARBI ANGLONG -> AGREEMENT
2022 ASSAM-MEGHALAYA -> INTER-STATE BOUNDARY AGREEMENT
2023 DNLA / UNLF / ULFA PRO-TALKS -> DISTINCT INSTRUMENTS
2024 TIPRA MOTHA -> TRIPARTITE AGREEMENT

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Manipur SoO status

4 SEP 2025 -> REVISED UPF / KNO GROUND RULES SIGNED
STATED VALIDITY -> THROUGH 3 SEP 2026
STATUS -> CESSATION-OF-HOSTILITIES RUNG
NOT PROVED -> FINAL SETTLEMENT / DISARMAMENT / REINTEGRATION

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: AFSPA legal architecture

SECTION 3 -> DISTURBED-AREA NOTIFICATION
SECTION 4 -> POWERS IN NOTIFIED AREA
SECTION 6 -> PRIOR CENTRAL SANCTION BEFORE PROSECUTION
COURTS -> CONSTITUTIONALITY WITH SAFEGUARDS; NO ABSOLUTE IMMUNITY
MUST REMEMBER: North-East insurgencies differ by history, territorial demand, ethnic...
MUST REMEMBER: North-East insurgencies differ by history, territorial demand, ethnic...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: FMR and border-policy boundary

8 FEB 2024 -> DECISION ANNOUNCEMENT
SECURITY CONCERN -> misuse, movement, narcotics, identity conflict
COMMUNITY COST -> kinship, livelihood and small trade
RULE -> operative regime requires formal notification
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Ceasefire is not final settlement, Suspension of Operations is not...
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Ceasefire is not final settlement, Suspension of Operations is not...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: PYQ map and end-state

CHALLENGES -> IDENTITY / BORDER / DEVELOPMENT / TRUST
MAP -> STATE + FACTION + DATE + INSTRUMENT RUNG
AUDIT -> AFSPA ACCOUNTABILITY + ACCORD IMPLEMENTATION
REFORM -> RECONCILIATION + BORDER GOVERNANCE + CLEAR MANDATES
CONCLUDE -> VERIFIED DELIVERY, NOT SIGNATURE COUNT
EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: Name parties, date and legal or political...
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